

Hotel Reception

Product Requirements Document

V1.0 - Pilot Release

Purpose

Give Reception one hotel-wide operational workspace to monitor, coordinate, communicate, and resolve guest-service requests.

Operating role

Reception is the guest-service control point - not a hotel configuration or administration role.

CONFIDENTIAL

Prepared for product design, engineering, pilots, and future implementation reference.

Document Control

Item	Detail
Product	RoomLink
Document	Hotel Reception Product Requirements Document
Version	V1.0 - Pilot Release
Classification	Confidential
Platform	Responsive web / PWA
Primary user	Hotel Reception / Front Desk
Pilot scenarios	110-room hotel with managers; 15-room hotel with cross-department staff

1. Objective

RoomLink is a digital hotel intercom. Reception needs a simple, hotel-wide control point to ensure no guest request is missed, delayed, or sent to the wrong team.

- See all active guest requests across every enabled department.
- Communicate with the guest and coordinate the right department, manager, or eligible staff member.
- Assign, reassign, escalate, and follow requests through to completion.
- Keep configuration and people administration with the Hotel Admin / GM.

Reception has hotel-wide guest-service visibility, even when departments have their own managers.

2. Role, Permissions and Boundaries

Reception can	Reception cannot
Monitor all requests and guest messages across the hotel.	Add/deactivate staff, configure departments, change hotel profile, menu, settings, rooms or QR codes.
Assign/reassign work to department managers or eligible staff.	Access another hotel or RoomLink platform administration.
Communicate with guests, add internal notes, escalate, and close eligible requests.	Change GST/legal information or subscription settings.

3. Reception Dashboard

The first screen after login must be a live, action-first queue rather than a management dashboard.

Area	Requirements
Queue KPIs	New, unassigned, assigned, in progress, delayed/escalated, unread guest messages.
Live request list	Room, service, department, status, priority, assignee, elapsed time, and last update.
Alerts	Unassigned request, SLA risk/breach, critical maintenance, guest reply, staff unavailable.
Quick actions	Open request, assign, reassign, message guest, escalate, add note, update status.

4. Hotel-Wide Request Monitoring

Reception sees requests from all enabled hotel departments, including Housekeeping, Restaurant, Maintenance, Room Service, Laundry, Spa & Wellness, Concierge / Transport, and custom departments.

- Search and filter by room, department, status, priority, assignee and date.
- Sort by newest, longest waiting, priority, and SLA risk.
- Use clear state badges: New, Assigned, In Progress, Completed, Cancelled, Escalated.
- Show history: who accepted/assigned/updated the request and when.

5. Request Detail and Guest Communication

Request detail	Requirement
Guest context	Room, active session status, request/service, notes, timestamps, and current status.
Conversation	Two-way guest messages; delivery/read state where supported; polite response templates for common updates.
Internal notes	Private notes visible to hotel staff, managers and GM, but not the guest.
Actions	Assign/reassign, change priority, escalate, mark in progress/completed/cancelled where role rules allow.

6. Assignment and Routing

RoomLink routes a request to its configured department. Reception coordinates the final operational hand-off.

Department setup	Reception workflow
Manager exists	Assign or notify the Department Manager; manager may assign the departmental staff. Reception continues to monitor and can intervene.
No manager	Assign directly to eligible department staff.
Multi-department staff	A staff member can be selected when they belong to the request department, even if they belong to other departments too.
No available recipient	Keep request unassigned, flag it clearly, alert Reception/GM, and provide an escalation path.

For V1, department membership means staff eligibility. Service-specific skills and scheduling logic are future scope.

7. Status, Escalation and SLA

State	Reception requirement
New	Visible immediately in the active queue; requires acknowledgement or assignment.
Assigned	Show assignee and time assigned; Reception follows progress.
In Progress	Show active work and latest staff/manager update.
Completed	Guest is informed; request stays in history.
Cancelled	Record the reason and actor.
Escalated	Flag prominently; record reason, level, recipients and resolution.

- Escalate delayed, unassigned, repeated, high-priority or critical guest requests.
- Escalation recipients may include Department Manager and Hotel Admin / GM.
- V1 uses configurable operational alerting; advanced SLA policy engines are later scope.

8. Guest Session Awareness

Reception can see whether the guest session for a room is active and use that context while assisting the guest. Reception does not administer room QR codes or manually create hotel room records. The QR identifies hotel + room; verified temporary stay sessions protect access.

9. Department-Specific Handling

Department	Reception handling
Housekeeping	Route items such as towels, water, toiletries, cleaning, pillows or blankets; coordinate when guest timing matters.
Maintenance	Recognize AC, TV, Wi-Fi, plumbing and electricity as potentially urgent; prioritize critical safety or comfort issues.
Restaurant	Route food orders to Restaurant; communicate availability and order progress where provided.
Custom services	Follow the department routing defined by the Hotel Admin / GM.

10. Notifications

Reception must receive in-app and push notifications for new requests, guest messages, assignments needing attention, critical requests, delays/SLA risks, and staff or department issues. Email/SMS are not required in V1.

11. Reception Navigation

Navigation	Purpose
Dashboard / Live Queue	Immediate request triage and alerts.
Requests	Full request history and filtering.
Guest Messages	Conversation-focused view, including unread items.
Activity	Operational activity relevant to Reception.
Notifications	Alert inbox and preferences allowed for the role.
Profile	Own account and sign-out.

12. UX Requirements

- Desktop-first, responsive PWA; usable on a front-desk tablet.
- Triage requires minimal clicks: request -> inspect -> assign/message/escalate.
- Clear visual priority, status, department and elapsed-time cues.
- Show loading, empty, error and success feedback states on every screen.
- Destructive actions and closure/cancellation require confirmation and a reason where applicable.

13. Audit and Activity

Every material Reception action is recorded in the request timeline: assignment, reassignment, priority change, message, status update, escalation, cancellation and completion. The Hotel Admin / GM can view this activity; the platform security audit remains with Super Admin.

14. Acceptance Criteria

Area	Acceptance criteria
Visibility	Reception sees every active guest request and message for its hotel.
Triage	Reception can filter, sort and find requests by room, department, status, priority and assignee.
Coordination	Reception can assign/reassign to a Department Manager or eligible staff member.
Communication	Reception can message the guest and add internal notes.
Control	Reception can escalate, track status, and close/cancel only with appropriate reason controls.
Boundaries	Reception cannot change hotel configuration, users, departments, menu, rooms, QR, legal or GST data.
Auditability	All material actions appear in the request timeline.

15. Pilot Acceptance Tests

Pilot	Required Reception test
Hotel A - 110 rooms	Reception receives a guest QR request, sees the correct department, assigns/escalates to the Department Manager, monitors staff completion, messages the guest, and resolves the request.
Hotel B - 15 rooms	Reception receives a maintenance, housekeeping or restaurant request and assigns Raju when he is eligible through his multi-department membership; no Department Manager is required.
Both pilots	A photographed static QR cannot bypass the verified temporary guest session; Reception sees active-session context only.

16. Non-Goals

- Hotel configuration, staff provisioning, rooms/QR configuration, menu management and GST/legal management.
- PMS, reservation and full check-in/check-out management.
- Payroll, inventory, accounting, restaurant POS, advanced workforce scheduling.
- AI chatbot, loyalty, advanced CRM, email/SMS notification channels.

17. Final V1 Principle

Reception is RoomLink's hotel-wide guest-service coordination layer: every guest request is visible, owned, communicated, and followed through - regardless of whether a department has a manager.

The Reception workspace must stay operationally simple: help the front desk respond quickly, route work correctly, and keep the guest informed.